

POLICY RESEARCH PROCESS

Researcher's Race, Class, Gender, Age, Ethnicity, and Nationality

Research interest/
purpose

Are you evaluating an existing
policy?

Do you wish to make policy
recommendations to address a
problem?

Identify the policy to evaluate

Establish the context

Delineate the historical conditions within which
the policy was developed

Reveal the biases & interests of the policy's
authors

Establish the mechanisms of
implementation

Determine the level of implementation

Identify agency of implementation:
private or public

Determine the person/group with responsibility,
authority, ways & means, and enforcement

International
National
Regional, state, county
Municipality, city

Establish evaluation criteria

Consider cost, benefit, effectiveness, efficiency, equity,
administrative ease, legality, & political acceptability

Assess feasibility of study

Conceptual
Framework

Develop model of relationship
& outcomes, feedback, central
stakeholders, etc.

Clarify
Parameters
Of Study

Assess the boundaries &
influential forces in system

Examine decision-making &
delivery mechanisms

Evaluate the impact of the policy on
its intended target population

Identify alternative policies

Evaluate alternative policies

Display and distinguish among
alternative policies

Monitor the implemented policy

Display and distinguish among
alternative policies

Verify, define, detail the problem, &
identify research objectives

Delineate interested parties, their
agendas, & outcomes

Literature
Review

preliminary review to
clearly define research
problem

Research
Problem

Examine/assess/evaluate how the
problem impacts various members
of society

Identify existing policies that
address problem

Evaluate degree to which policy
does/not address social problem

Present to decision-makers

Implement policy

Evaluate impact/effectiveness of
policy

Provide consultation